PLAYER 2 LEVEL UP · POLICY

SAFEGUARDING AND CHILD PROTECTION POLICY

POLICY OWNER	Rory Horseman, Owner, Player 2 Level Up
SAFEGUARDING LEAD	Rory Horseman
DATE ADOPTED	11 November 2026
NEXT REVIEW	11 November 2027

1. OUR COMMITMENT

Player 2 Level Up is committed to safeguarding and promoting the welfare of all children and young people who participate in our online gaming sessions.

We aim to provide a safe, inclusive and supportive environment where young people feel respected, listened to and protected from harm.

We recognise that online gaming offers opportunities for social interaction, confidence and personal development, but may also present safeguarding risks.

Safeguarding is everyone's responsibility. All concerns will be taken seriously and acted upon promptly. The welfare of the young person will always be our priority.

2. RECOGNISING SAFEGUARDING CONCERNS

All mentors and staff must be alert to signs of abuse, neglect or harm, including:

- Physical, emotional or sexual abuse and neglect.
- Online grooming, exploitation and inappropriate contact.
- Cyberbullying, harassment and discrimination.
- Inappropriate sexual content or requests for images.
- Threats, coercion, manipulation or financial exploitation.
- Self-harm, suicidal thoughts or significant emotional distress.
- Any behaviour or disclosure suggesting that a young person may be unsafe.

Concerns may arise through conversations, gameplay, messages, behaviour changes or direct disclosures.

Staff do not need proof of abuse before reporting a concern.

3. SAFE WORKING PRACTICES

All staff and mentors must:

- Maintain appropriate professional boundaries.
- Use their Player 2 staff accounts, protected with two-step verification, and approved communication channels.

- Avoid unauthorised private contact outside sessions.
- Never be alone on a call or in a voice channel with a young person, except during a booked One-2-One session, which is recorded.
- Never request or share inappropriate images or personal information.
- Follow our Online Safety and Age-Appropriate Games policies.
- Respect confidentiality while understanding when information must be shared to protect a young person.
- Report concerns about the behaviour or conduct of colleagues.

Staff must never promise to keep safeguarding concerns secret.

4. RESPONDING TO A CONCERN OR DISCLOSURE

If a young person shares something worrying or a mentor identifies a safeguarding concern, they must:

1. **Listen calmly** and take the concern seriously.
2. **Reassure the young person** without making promises of secrecy.
3. **Avoid investigating** or asking unnecessary or leading questions.
4. **Consider immediate safety** and contact emergency services if the young person is in immediate danger.
5. **Report the concern promptly** to the Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL).
6. **Record the facts accurately**, including the date, time, the young person's words and any actions taken.
7. **Keep the evidence** from the Discord server, such as messages, activity log entries or a recording, before removing anything, so it is not lost. Suspected indecent images of children must never be downloaded, forwarded or circulated.

Concerns must be reported as soon as possible, normally on the same day.

Staff must not confront an alleged perpetrator or attempt to investigate allegations themselves.

5. REPORTING AND SAFEGUARDING PROCEDURES

The DSL is responsible for assessing concerns, maintaining safeguarding records and making referrals to the relevant authorities when necessary.

Where a young person may be at risk of significant harm, the DSL will contact children's social care and/or the police as appropriate.

Parents and carers will normally be involved where appropriate, unless doing so could increase the risk of harm or compromise an investigation.

If a concern involves a member of staff, it must be reported to the DSL or an appropriate alternative safeguarding contact. Allegations meeting the relevant threshold will be referred to the Local Authority Designated Officer (LADO).

> **If a child is in immediate danger, call 999. Do not wait for the DSL.**

If the DSL is unavailable, staff must contact children's social care or the police directly where necessary to protect the child.

6. STAFF SUITABILITY AND TRAINING

Everyone working with young people must follow our safeguarding procedures and Staff Code of Conduct.

We will carry out appropriate recruitment and suitability checks, including DBS checks where legally eligible and required, and provide safeguarding induction and training relevant to each role.

Staff must understand how to recognise, respond to and report concerns. Any concerns about staff conduct or suitability will be addressed promptly.

7. CONFIDENTIALITY AND RECORD KEEPING

Safeguarding information will be recorded accurately, stored securely and shared only with those who need it to protect a young person or fulfil a legal responsibility.

Records will be maintained in accordance with our Data Protection Policy.

Discord activity logs, AutoMod alerts and session recordings can be used as evidence when a concern is raised. Where they are needed, they are kept as part of the safeguarding record and may be shared with children's social care, the police or the LADO.

Safeguarding information may be shared without consent where there is a lawful basis and doing so is necessary to protect a child from harm.

8. SAFEGUARDING CONTACTS

Designated Safeguarding Lead: Rory Horseman
Email: player2levelup@gmail.com

Local Authority Children's Social Care: 01926 414144

Local Authority Designated Officer (LADO): 01926 745376

Warwickshire Emergency Duty Team (out of hours): 01926 886922

Emergency Services: 999
Police Non-Emergency: 101

9. POLICY REVIEW

This policy will be reviewed at least annually and following any significant safeguarding incident or relevant change in guidance.

It should be read alongside our Online Safety, Behaviour, Safer Recruitment, Age-Appropriate Games and Data Protection policies.

Approved by Rory Horseman, Owner, Player 2 Level Up, on 11 November 2026. Next review due 11 November 2027.